

Centres must ensure that the learner authentication section is completed for each learner by both the learner and teacher.

Learners must sign a declaration to confirm that, apart from collaboration with other learners and general guidance from the teacher, where these are acceptable within the parameters of the specification, the work which they submit for final assessment is their own unaided work.

Teachers must sign a declaration of authentication after the work has been completed confirming that:

- any assistance which goes beyond general guidance has been recorded and taken into account when marking the work
- otherwise, apart from general guidance given in line with the parameters set out in the specification, the work is solely that of the learner concerned
- the work was completed under the required conditions
- signed learner declarations are kept on file.

3. Mark sheet section

Teachers complete this form when they mark the work, providing a mark breakdown. Teachers must clearly show how the marks have been awarded in relation to the marking criteria. A combination of the following approaches should be adopted:

- summary comments either on the work (usually at the end) or on a cover sheet
- key pieces of evidence flagged throughout the work by annotation in the margin.

Indications as to how marks have been awarded should:

- be clear and unambiguous
- be appropriate to the nature and form of the work
- facilitate the standardisation of marking within the centre to enable the moderator to check the application of the assessment criteria to the marking.

Missing or incomplete Geography Independent Investigation Forms

The following information should be read in conjunction with section 9 of the JCQ *Instructions for conducting non-examination assessment*.

If a Geography Independent Investigation form is found to be missing or incomplete, the Awarding Organisation will in the first instance contact the centre to rectify the matter. If this request is not addressed satisfactorily, the Awarding Organisation will take further action, which may lead to a malpractice investigation.

Detecting malpractice

Malpractice may be suspected by teachers in learner work as follows:

- the style of writing is not typical of the learner; it might be from published material, or from another person
- there are instances of the same errors in the work of two or more learners
- there are passages quoted from publications or the internet which are not acknowledged in the bibliography or by in-text referencing
- there are passages copied from examples of good practice which were distributed to the whole class
- the work of one learner is copied from another.

Dealing with malpractice

By centres:

- if the centre/teacher suspects some form of malpractice, the centre must take action to investigate internally. The centre should have in place procedures to deal with these issues across qualifications
- the learner and teacher should only complete the authentication section of the Geography Independent Investigation form once it is clear which parts of the work are the learner's own. If the matter is not resolved the learner should be awarded zero.

Consequences of malpractice

If malpractice is suspected, the Awarding Organisation will investigate. If malpractice is found to have taken place a penalty will be given dependent on the circumstances and severity of the malpractice.

For full information regarding malpractice please see the JCQ document 'Suspected Malpractice in Examinations and Assessments'.